

Kaiwen Fan

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EDUCATION

University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA
Bachelor of Art & Design: Games + Playable Media (B.A.)

September 2023 – Present
Expected Graduation June 2026

GPA: 3.68/4.0, **Honors:** Dean's List (multiple quarters)

Relevant Coursework: Relevant Coursework: UI/UX Prototyping, Designing Experiences, Game Design I, Foundations of Game Design, Computer Programming for the Arts

EXPERIENCE

UCSC Admissions Office, Santa Cruz, CA August 2023 – September 2024
International Student Ambassador & Content Creator

- Produced 10+ official promotional videos reaching 5,000+ prospective students across Chinese social media platforms.
- Directed, filmed, and edited short digital content highlighting student life, academic resources, and campus culture.
- Hosted Q&A sessions and cultural events, supporting prospective international students in adapting to campus life.

Chinese Students & Scholars Association (CSSA), UCSC, Santa Cruz, CA Sep 2024 – Jun 2025
Human Resources & Secretary

- Coordinated internal communication and organized member information to support team operations
- Assisted in planning and executing student events, improving participation and engagement

PROJECTS

Web Interaction Experiments (HTML/CSS/JS), Santa Cruz, CA September 2025 - present
UX / Interaction Designer & Developer

- Built interactive web prototypes using HTML/CSS/JS, including mouse-tracking and animated feedback systems to enhance user engagement
- Designed intuitive interaction flows to improve usability, responsiveness, and user engagement

Godot 3D game - BugShroom, Santa Cruz, CA September 2025 – November 2025
UI Designer & Visual Designer

- Designed in-game UI systems to improve clarity of player feedback and navigation
- Created visual assets and final game cover, establishing a cohesive visual identity

Ren'Py Narrative Game The Pack, Santa Cruz, CA September 2025 – November 2025
Systems Designer & Writer & Programmer

- Developed branching narrative systems supporting player-driven interaction and progression
- Implemented scripting logic to improve interaction flow and narrative responsiveness

Interactive Fiction Echoes Beyond the Gate, Santa Cruz, CA September 2025
Game Designer

- Built a branching interactive fiction using conditional logic, state tracking, and multi-ending narrative structure.

Ren'Py RPG Too Much on Your Plate, Santa Cruz, CA April 2024 – June 2024
Mechanic & Narrative Designer

- Designed a text-input narrative mechanic that parses player-written responses for keywords to trigger conditional branching outcomes.
- Co-wrote world-building, branching romance routes, and dialogue pacing integrated with Ren'Py story systems.

Interactive Fiction - Echoes Beyond the Gate, Santa Cruz, CA April 2024 – June 2024
Game & Narrative Designer

- Designed a branching narrative experience focused on player agency and engagement
- Structured multi-ending story paths using conditional logic and state tracking

SKILLS

Design: UI/UX Design, Interaction Design, Prototyping, User-Centered Design, Visual Design

Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python

Tools: Photoshop, Illustrator, Blender, Ren'Py

Languages: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)